

Third-party payment continuity

Correspondence with the Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services — August 17 to September 11, 2026

Seven questions were put to the Minister in writing on August 17, 2026, about what happened to third-party rent payments and Financial Administrator arrangements when files moved from AISH to ADAP. An automated acknowledgement arrived the same minute. A substantive response arrived twenty-five days later and answered one of the seven questions. Two follow-up emails were sent the same afternoon, bringing the number of outstanding questions to ten.

The full exchange is reproduced below, in order and without alteration.

1. Letter to the Minister

From: Chantal Trepanier, The Alberta Disability System Breakdown
To: ALSS Minister; GOA ADAP Engagement; St. Albert constituency office
Sent: Monday, August 17, 2026, 1:04 PM

Dear Minister Neudorf,

I write on behalf of The Alberta Disability System Breakdown to request written clarification on the treatment of third-party payment and financial administrator arrangements during the transition from AISH to the Alberta Disability Assistance Program. We are placing this question in writing so that the answer forms part of the public record on the transition.

Section 12.7(1) of the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act, as amended by Bill 12 (SA 2025 c20 s.6), provides that a director may continue paying a third party all or part of a benefit where such payment was in place immediately before the provision came into force. Section 12.7(3) applies the same permissive language to financial administrators. Neither provision requires continuation. Section 6, as substituted, conditions third-party payment on the client's consent.

For a recipient whose rent reaches the landlord through one of these arrangements, the difference between a provision that permits continuation and one that requires it is the difference between housing that holds and housing that does not. We have received accounts from recipients who report that a direct rent payment stopped after their file moved to ADAP. We are not publishing those accounts as findings. We are asking the department to state the operating position.

We request written answers to the following:

1. Were existing third-party payment arrangements carried forward automatically on transition under section 12.6, or did continuation require an action by the client, the third party, or the department?
2. The same question for financial administrator arrangements under section 12.7(3).
3. Did the consent requirement in section 6 require a client's consent to be re-executed for arrangements predating the amended Act, and what became of arrangements where it had not been re-executed before the first ADAP payment period?
4. Where an arrangement did not continue, what notice was issued, to whom, and on what date?
5. What is the process and expected processing time for a client to re-establish a direct payment arrangement?
6. Where is this published for clients and their support workers?
7. How many files had a third-party payment or financial administrator arrangement in place immediately before July 2, 2026, and in how many did that arrangement remain in effect for the first ADAP payment period?

We would appreciate a response within 15 business days. We will relay the department's answer to our members without alteration.

Respectfully,
Chantal Trepanier
The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

2. Automated acknowledgement

From: ALSS Minister

Sent: Monday, August 17, 2026, 1:04 PM — the same minute the letter was sent

Thank you for reaching out to the Ministry of Assisted Living and Social Services. Please be assured that your request has been received and will be reviewed.

Minister Neudorf sincerely appreciates your message and your interest in engaging with our office.

Given the volume of requests currently being received, the Minister's Office is reviewing meeting and event opportunities in alignment with ministry priorities and scheduling availability.

Should a meeting or event be feasible, a member of the Minister's team will follow up with you directly to coordinate next steps.

[The acknowledgement then lists crisis and support telephone numbers: the Income Support Contact Centre, the Family Violence Info Line, the Child Abuse Hotline, the Bullying Helpline, the Mental Health Help Line and the Alberta Supports Contact Centre.]

3. Response from the Minister

From: ALSS Minister

Sent: Friday, September 11, 2026, 2:48 PM — twenty-five days after the letter

Dear Chantal Trepanier:

Thank you for your email regarding the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program, the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP), third-party payments and the role of Financial Administrators. As Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services, I appreciate the opportunity to respond.

AISH and ADAP clients may be assisted in managing their benefits through an informal trustee, referred to as a Financial Administrator, who is appointed under the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act and AISH Regulations. Clients may need assistance managing their financial benefits when they lack the capacity to meet their basic needs and/or have an established a pattern of using their benefits in a way that puts their health at risk. AISH legislation requires a client's consent to the Financial Administrator appointment, except in cases where a medical professional has determined the client lacks the capacity to make financial decisions. In situations where the client does not have mental or physical capacity or will not consent to the Financial Administrator appointment, AISH or ADAP may appoint a Financial Administrator without consent. Financial Administrator appointments that were in place prior to July 2026 remained in effect for all AISH and ADAP, clients including those who transitioned between the programs.

Regarding third-party rent payments, a temporary system issue resulted in some payments being deposited directly to client bank accounts rather than issued to landlords. Clients were notified of this issue and advised to forward payments to landlords directly. The issue is now resolved, and future third-party payments will continue to be issued directly to the appropriate recipients.

Please be assured that disability income assistance will continue to be available for Albertans who rely on it to meet their needs. Alberta has the highest provincial disability benefit rates and most robust disability programs in Canada, and we continue to expand and improve these supports. Through Budget 2026, Alberta's government is investing a historic \$3.7 billion to support Albertans with disabilities this year alone, a year-over-year increase of almost \$100 million. Since 2019, this represents more than \$1 billion in additional investment, which is an increase of nearly 40 per cent.

Thank you again for writing.

Sincerely,

Honourable Nathan Neudorf

Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services

4. Follow-up to the Minister

From: Chantal Trepanier, The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

To: ALSS Minister | CC: St. Albert constituency office

Sent: Friday, September 11, 2026, 3:10 PM, and again later the same afternoon

Two follow-up emails were sent on the afternoon of September 11. The first, at 3:10 PM, set out the six unanswered questions and one new question arising from the response. The second, sent shortly afterwards, repeated those and added the section on Financial Administrators together with three further questions. The second email is reproduced below in full; it contains the text of the first.

Dear Minister Neudorf,

Thank you for your response of September 11, 2026 to my letter of August 17.

I note the confirmation that a system issue resulted in third-party rent payments being deposited to client accounts rather than issued to landlords. That is a useful acknowledgement and I am grateful to have it in writing. I note also the confirmation that Financial Administrator appointments in place before July 2026 remained in effect through the transition.

That is one of my seven questions answered, together with a paragraph on Budget 2026 that I did not ask about.

On the claim that the issue is resolved

Your letter states that the issue is now resolved. I am not able to reconcile that with what I am being told.

One hundred and forty-five people came to me with incorrect payments across two consecutive payment periods. I drafted a letter for each of them. They sent those letters themselves, from their own accounts, so I cannot tell you how many reached your department or when. I can tell you that one hundred and forty-five separate individuals had a payment go wrong and came to a stranger on the internet for help with it, because they could not get help elsewhere.

I also published a template letter for people I never spoke to. I have no way of knowing how many used it.

If the issue was resolved, it was not resolved before the second month of it.

More troubling than the recurrence is how the failures came to light. Your letter says clients were notified and advised to forward payments to landlords directly. That is not the experience being described to me. In the accounts I hold, people learned that their rent had not reached their landlord from the landlord, in some cases after the rent was already late. They were not told by the department. They found out from the person they owed money to.

That distinction matters more than it may appear from a ministerial office. A tenant who is told in advance can forward the payment and keep the tenancy intact. A tenant who finds out from a late notice is already explaining themselves to a landlord, already on a record, and in some cases already facing a fee. The harm is not the misdirected payment. The harm is the silence around it.

It also suggests the department did not identify every affected file. If notification depended on the department knowing which payments had gone astray, and people were not notified, then some failures were not detected at all. They surfaced because a landlord chased a tenant, not because a system caught an error.

This work is done by one unfunded person from her living room. I answer in the region of ten thousand messages a week and I do not leave one unanswered at the end of a day. If one hundred and forty-five people can find their way to an unfunded advocate in two months because their payment was wrong, I would expect the department issuing those payments to be able to identify the same failures.

On Financial Administrators specifically

There is a difficulty in your letter that I want to set out plainly, because it concerns the most vulnerable people on your caseload.

Your letter explains that a Financial Administrator is appointed where a client lacks the capacity to meet their basic needs, or has an established pattern of using their benefits in a way that puts their health at risk, and that an appointment may be made without consent where a medical professional has determined the client lacks capacity to make financial decisions.

Your letter then explains that payments were deposited directly into client bank accounts, and that clients were advised to forward those payments to landlords themselves.

Those two paragraphs concern the same people.

The department's stated basis for the arrangement is that the individual cannot reliably manage the money. The department's response to the failure was to place the money in that individual's hands and ask them to manage it.

For some of these clients there is a medical determination on file stating they lack the capacity to make financial decisions. They were nonetheless expected to receive an unexpected sum, recognise it was not theirs, and redirect it correctly, in many cases without being told it had happened.

The questions that remain

Six of my original seven are unanswered. In case the original wording was the obstacle, I have made them shorter.

1. When someone's rent was being paid straight to their landlord before July 2, did that keep happening automatically after they moved to ADAP, or did somebody have to do something to keep it going? If somebody had to do something, who?
2. Did clients have to sign a new consent form for arrangements that already existed? If they did not sign one in time, what happened to the arrangement?
3. When an arrangement stopped, who was told, how, and on what date?
4. If someone's rent payment stopped and they want it back, what do they do and how long does it take?
5. Where is any of this written down where a client or a support worker can read it?
6. How many files had a third-party payment or Financial Administrator arrangement immediately before July 2, 2026, and in how many did it continue into the first ADAP payment period?

Your response raises four further questions.

7. On what date was the system issue resolved? By what method were affected clients notified, and on what date were those notifications sent? How did the department identify which files were affected, and how can it be confident that every affected client was notified?
8. Where a client had a Financial Administrator or third-party payment arrangement in place and a payment was deposited to the client's own account in error, what steps did the department take beyond advising the client to forward it? Was the Financial Administrator notified? Was the landlord notified?
9. Where the money was not forwarded, and rent was consequently unpaid, what is the department's position on responsibility for the resulting arrears, late fees, or loss of tenancy? Will the department make those clients whole?
10. Has the department identified how many of the misdirected payments went to clients with a Financial Administrator appointment in place, including appointments made without consent on the basis of a medical determination of incapacity?

I would ask you to consider question 9 with particular care. The department determined that these individuals could not be relied upon to manage their own funds. The department then required them to do so. Where that resulted in harm, the department's own assessment of their capacity is the reason it was foreseeable.

I will relay whatever answer I receive to our members without alteration, as I said in August. If the answer to any of these is that the department does not hold the information, I will publish that too, and I would rather publish it from you than infer it from silence.

I would appreciate a response within 15 business days.

Respectfully,

Chantal Trepanier

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

Where this stands

Question 2, on Financial Administrator arrangements, is answered. Appointments in place before July 2026 remained in effect across the transition.

Questions 1, 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7 of the original seven are not addressed.

The response also volunteers something that was not asked: confirmation that a system issue caused third-party rent payments to be deposited to client accounts rather than issued to landlords, that clients were notified, and that the issue is resolved. Each of those three statements is worth holding on to.

Ten questions are now outstanding. A response was requested within 15 business days. Whatever comes back will be published here in the same way.

THE ALBERTA DISABILITY SYSTEM BREAKDOWN

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